



Giant kelp,
Worldwide



*Giant kelp
can grow 60 cm
(2 ft) a day and reach
45 m (148 ft) high – as
tall as a rainforest tree.*

Kelp

Have you ever brushed your teeth? Washed your hair? Eaten ice cream? If the answer is yes, then you have probably used kelp! An ingredient from kelp is often added to toothpaste, shampoo, and puddings. Kelp is a monster seaweed that creates underwater forests. Many animals hide among its wide ribbons, including fish, octopuses, and sea otters.

Kelp is a type of brown algae (al-gee). There are many kinds of brown algae, and not all are big – some are made of hairlike threads only a few centimetres long. Like green algae, brown algae make food using sunlight. Some types have floats filled with gas, like balloons. This keeps their slimy fronds near the sea's sunny surface.

